Japan

The fighting carried on in the Pacific until 1945. Major attacks were carried out by the Allies in Okinawa, Iwo Jima, and Leyte. Majority of the territories that Japan had seized were freed by the Allied forces by this time. A critical military decision was made by Harry Truman, the 33rd president of the United States. The Allies were going to invade Japan, which would have likely killed thousands of Americans. Instead, Truman approved the use of nuclear weapons on Japan. In 1945, two atomic bombs were dropped from American planes on Nagasaki and Hiroshima. The destruction of these bombs was so great that Japan surrendered soon after.